



Fiona Stanley Fremantle Hospitals Group

Guideline

Physical Health Assessment Equipment, Availability in the Mental Health Setting

Reference #: FSFH-MENH-GUI-0008

Scope

Site	Service/Department/Unit	Disciplines
Fiona Stanley Hospital Fremantle Hospital	Mental Health Service	Medical, Nursing, Allied Health

1. Introduction

It is well recognised that impaired mental health may be associated with poor physical health. People with severe mental illness are known to have high rates of mortality, reduced life expectancy and decreased healthcare access.

This guideline ensures a minimum set of equipment is available in relevant areas of the Mental Health Service in order to complete an initial assessment and ongoing monitoring of a patient/consumers physical health. Variation in equipment that is available can impact on the quality of the assessment completed.

2. Terminology

Physical Health	The state of being free from illness or injury. It covers a wide range of areas including healthy diet, healthy weight, dental health, personal hygiene and sleep. Physical health is vital for overall well-being.
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3. Guideline

3.1. Requirements

All consumers of the FSFHG mental health service will have their physical health assessed and regularly monitored.

Patients admitted to the inpatient wards will have a physical examination on admission, or within 12 hours of admission as stipulated by the Mental Health Act 2014.

All community mental health consumers will have a physical healthcare examination on commencement and as required, or at minimum yearly as stipulated in the Chief Psychiatrists Standards for Clinical Care.

Physical examinations will be documented on the State-wide standardised clinical documentation Mental Health Physical Health Examination Form wherever possible.

Physical health assessment equipment will be available for the following:

- Inpatient wards
- Community Treatment Teams
- Fremantle Hospital Wellness Clinic

3.2. Equipment

3.2.1. Inpatient units and the Wellness Clinic will provide a treatment room which is well lit and allows the patients privacy to be maintained.

3.2.2. Hand hygiene facilities will be available in both inpatient and outpatient areas

3.2.3. Standard equipment will be available including:

- Stethoscope
- Sphygmomanometer
- Thermometer
- Tendon hammer
- Tuning fork (256Hz)
- Weighing scales
- Tape measure
- Height measure
- Auriscope
- Ophthalmoscope
- Snellen chart
- Glucometer and sticks
- Urinalysis sticks

- Oximetry machine
 - Peak flow meter
 - Disposable gloves
 - Pathology venepuncture and associated collection equipment
- 3.2.4. Community Treatment Teams will have access to a treatment room for the purposes of completing a physical examination of a community patient where required. The treatment rooms are located:
- FH Level 5 Health Clinic
 - FSH State Rehabilitation Service
- 3.2.5. Each community team will have access to the following standard equipment:
- Stethoscope
 - Sphygmomanometer
 - Thermometer
 - Weighing Scales
 - Tape measure
- 3.2.6. An Alcolmeter/breathalyser is available at FH Assessment and Treatment Team (ATT) on Level 4, W Block or in the FSH Mental Health Unit.

4. Compliance/Performance Monitoring

The availability of physical health assessment equipment in the inpatient treatment rooms and community treatment teams will be audited annually by senior nurses in the area and reported to the Physical Health Working Group for monitoring.

5. Related Policy Documents

WA Health

- [Department of Health 'Triage to Discharge' MH Framework for Statewide Standardised Clinical Documentation \(SSCD\)](#)

FSFHG

- Physical Health Care: Community Mental Health Consumers (FSFH-MENH-POL-0001)
- FSFHG Hand Hygiene (FSH-IPM-POL-0004)
- FSFHG Observation and Response Chart (FSFH-HW-POL-0032)

- FH Environmental Cleaning - FH (FSFH-HW-POL-0048)
- FSH Environmental cleaning (FSH-HW-POL-0002)

6. Related Standards

NSQHS Standards:

- Comprehensive care

National Standards for Mental Health Services:

- Delivery of Care

Chief Psychiatrist Standards for Clinical Care:

- Assessment
- Physical health care of mental health consumers

7. Authorisation

EXECUTIVE SPONSOR: Service Director, Service 5					
Version	Date Issued	Compiled/Revised By	Committee/Consumer Group Consulted	Endorsed By	Revision due
1	11/2015	CN	MH CGC	PLCC	03/20
2	09/2019	CNS, Clinical Improvement	NMPGC	FSFHG Policy Committee	09/2022
3	10/2022	CNS, Clinical Improvement	NMPGC	Service 5 Safety Quality and Risk Committee	10/2026

8. Appendices

8.1. Appendix 1: Essential Equipment Checklist – Community



Government of Western Australia
South Metropolitan Health Service
Fiona Stanley Fremantle Hospitals Group

ESSENTIAL EQUIPMENT CHECKLIST - Community

COMPLETED BY: [Click here to enter text.](#)

DATE: [Click here to enter text.](#)

WARD/AREA: Choose an item.

PHYSICAL HEALTH ASSESSMENT EQUIPMENT:

EQUIPMENT DESCRIPTION	AVAILABLE Y/N	COMMENT/S (If equipment NOT available)
Stethoscope	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Sphygmomanometer	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Thermometer	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Weighing scales	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Tape measure	YES ☐ NO ☐	

AUDIT PROVIDED TO:

- ☐ Clinical Nurse Specialist/Senior Nurse
- ☐ Physical Health Working Group

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8.2. Appendix 2: Essential Equipment Checklist for Treatment Rooms



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ESSENTIAL EQUIPMENT CHECKLIST FOR TREATMENT ROOMS

COMPLETED BY: [Click here to enter text.](#)

DATE: [Click here to enter text.](#)

WARD/AREA: Choose an item.

PHYSICAL HEALTH ASSESSMENT EQUIPMENT:

EQUIPMENT DESCRIPTION	AVAILABLE Y/N	COMMENT/S (If equipment NOT available)
Stethoscope	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Sphygmomanometer	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Thermometer	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Tendon hammer	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Tuning fork (256Hz)	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Weighing scales	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Tape measure	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Height measure	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Auriscopes	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Ophthalmoscope	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Snellen chart	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Glucometer	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Urinalysis sticks	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Oximetry machine	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Peak flow meter	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Disposable gloves	YES ☐ NO ☐	
Pathology venepuncture and associated collection equipment	YES ☐ NO ☐	

AUDIT PROVIDED TO:

- ☐ Nurse Unit Manager
- ☐ Physical Health Working Group

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